

White House Deluxe: Donald Trump Renovations Inc. [B2]

Casa Bianca o Casa Dorata? Le riforme apportate da Trump alla residenza storica dei presidenti degli Stati Uniti sono lontane dall'essere discrete.

The White House changes with each administration. The decoration and use of the rooms can be [rearranged](#) by each president and first family. While there are few details on former president Joe Biden's changes, his residency reportedly started with a \$127,000 "inaugural cleaning," as part of Covid-19 health and safety measures. President Trump's changes, on the other hand, [cannot fail to be noticed](#). The White House is turning gold. The Oval office is [gilded](#) on every surface, with gold trophies on the [mantlepiece](#), [gold trim](#) along the ceiling and [gold-framed portraits](#) on the walls. Some liken it to Versailles; others call it "[gaudy](#)." What is certain is that the aesthetics resemble those of Trump's Florida estate, Mar-a-Lago.

GOLDEN MAKEOVER

Similarly, the Cabinet Room has been subject to a golden [makeover](#). The walls are decorated with [twenty-four-carat](#) gold [decals](#). The windows are [draped](#) with gold curtains. Chandeliers hang from the ceiling and more flags have been added. The bathroom of the Lincoln Bedroom is also [decked out](#) in gold [against a marble backdrop](#). The famous Rose Garden in the West Wing has been [paved over](#). Now featuring [lawn furniture](#) and [striped parasols](#), it looks a lot like Mar-a-Lago's patio. Trump hosted his first gathering with Republican [lawmakers](#) there on 5 September. It has since been given the nickname The Rose Garden Club.

DEMOLITION

Over in the East Wing, the Jacqueline Kennedy Garden has been demolished to make room for Trump's most controversial addition: the White House [ballroom](#). In fact, most of the East Wing has been [torn down](#), [despite](#) initial

assurances to the contrary. The \$300 million construction is financed by private donors, including several Big Tech companies, [raising concerns](#) about ethics and historic legacy. The fact that the project started during a time of government shutdown and food insecurity has [drawn criticism](#) about the administration's priorities. A White House [spokesperson](#) told The Independent newspaper: "These long-needed upgrades will benefit generations of future presidents and American visitors to the People's House."

999 GUESTS

The White House has not yet confirmed whether the plans will include permanent offices for the first lady and her staff, currently working in the main building. Unlike her predecessors, Melania Trump does not live at the White House full-time. The [ballroom](#) is supposed to resolve the [issue](#) of [cramped space](#) for state functions. Where previously tents were erected on the lawn for big events, the [ballroom](#) will accommodate 999 people. The project is scheduled for completion before the end of President Trump's [term](#) in 2029. It is an ambitious deadline, but one thing is certain: it will feature a lot of gold. If you want to know more about this topic, read the articles [The White House: The Rooms Of Power](#) and [The Oval Office: The Most Famous Office In The World](#).

Glossary

- **striped parasols** = ombrelloni a righe
- **ballroom** = sala da ballo
- **despite** = nonostante
- **issue** = problema
- **term** = mandato
- **rearranged** = riorganizzare
- **makeover** = ristrutturazione, riforma
- **draped** = drappeggiare
- **drawn criticism** = sollevare critiche
- **spokesperson** = portavoce
- **gold trim** = rifiniture dorate
- **gaudy** = pacchiano
- **decals** = motivi ornamentali
- **decked out** = adornare
- **raising concerns** = suscitare preoccupazioni
- **cramped space** = spazio ristretto
- **cannot fail to be noticed** = è impossibile non accorgersene
- **gilded** = dorato
- **mantlepiece** = mensola del camino
- **twenty-four-carat** = di 24 carati
- **paved over** = pavimentare
- **lawn furniture** = mobili da giardino
- **lawmakers** = legislatori
- **torn down** = demolire
- **gold-framed portraits** = ritratti con cornici dorate
- **against a marble backdrop** = su uno sfondo di marmo